Little Red Riding Hood

starring Sarah

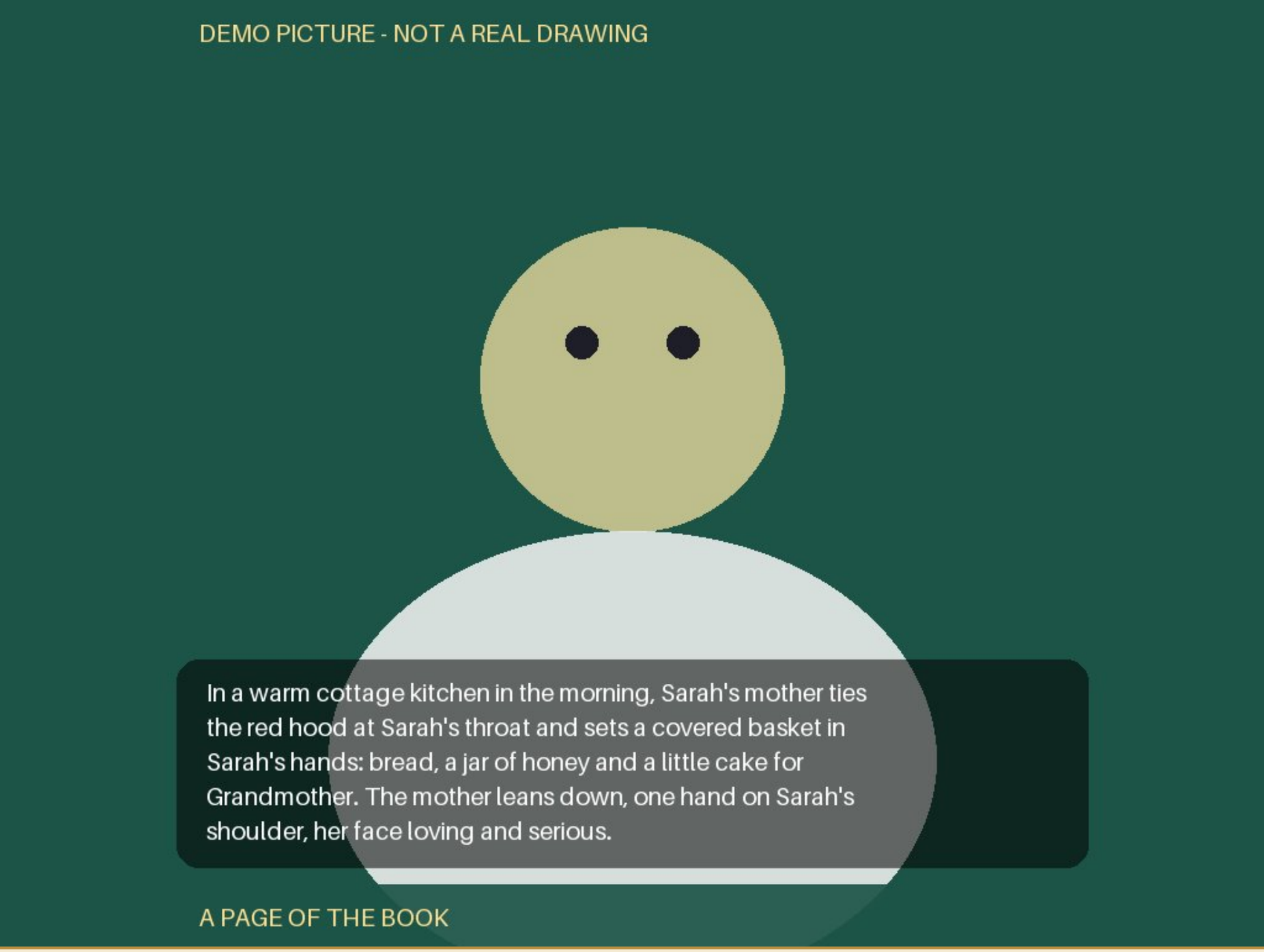


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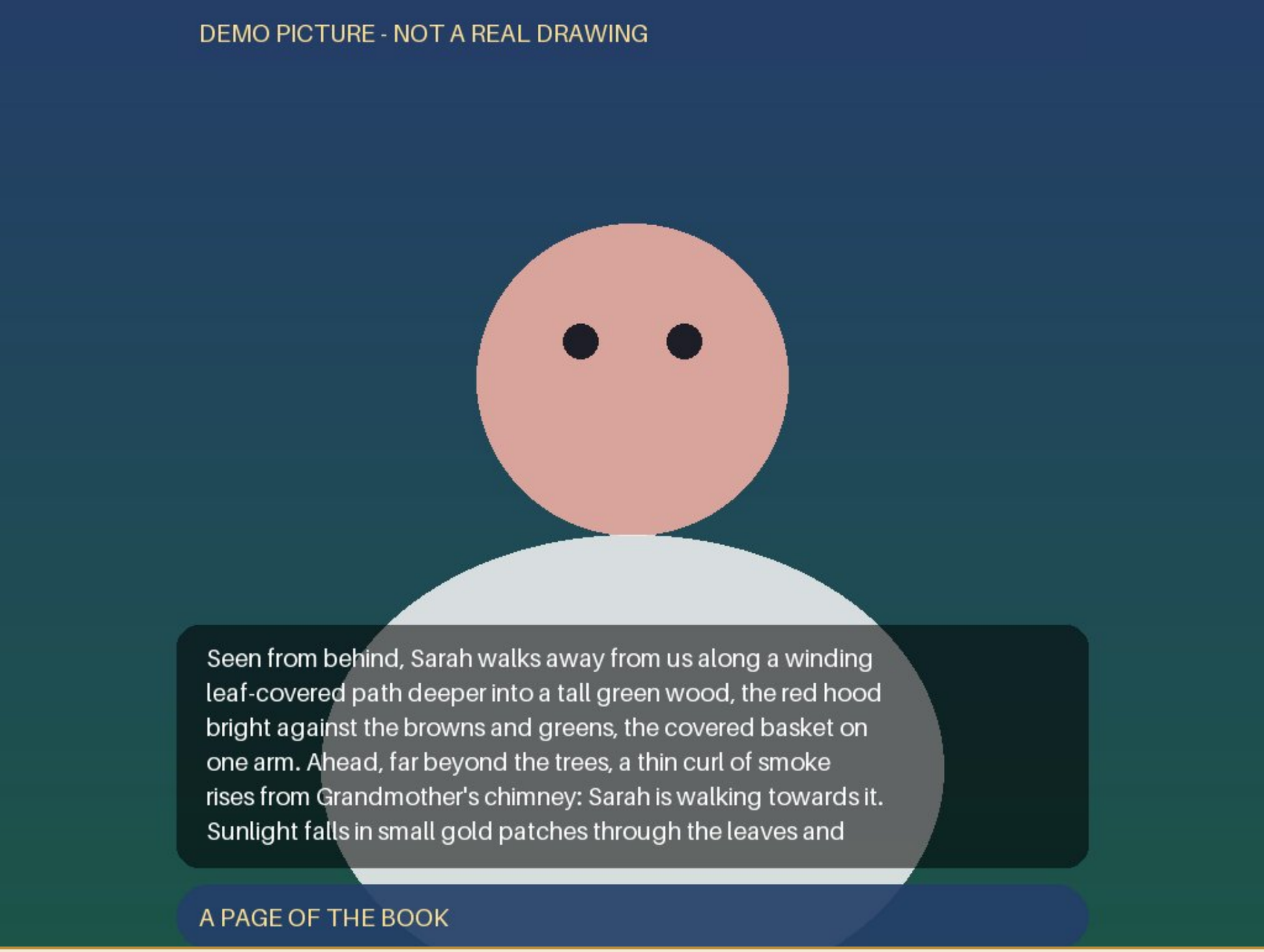
Made for Sarah.

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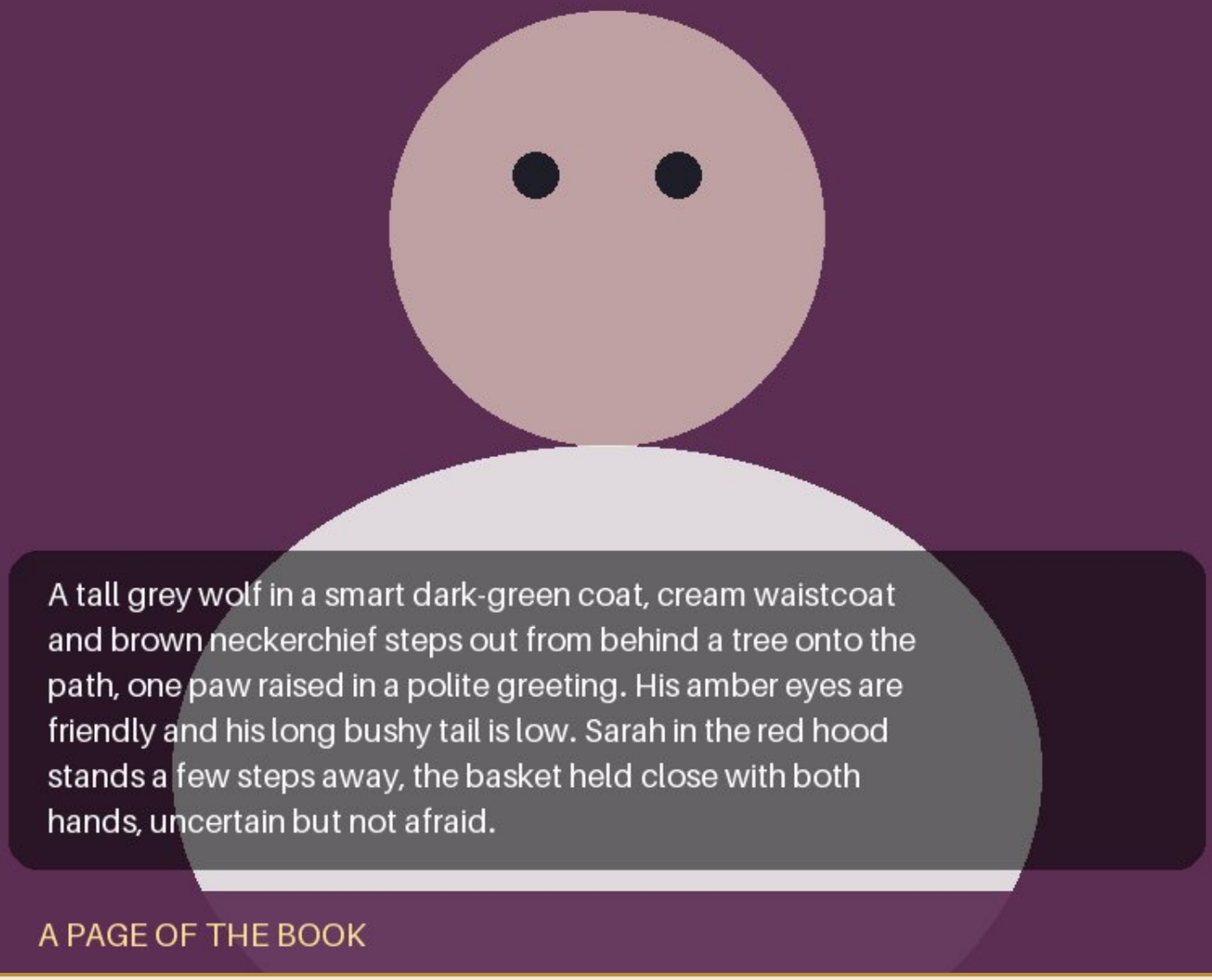


The morning was bright when Sarah set out. Her mother packed a basket with bread, honey and a little cake. They were for Grandmother, who lived on the other side of the wood. Sarah put on her red hood and took the basket by the handle. ‘Go straight there,’ said her mother. ‘Do not stop to talk to anyone.’



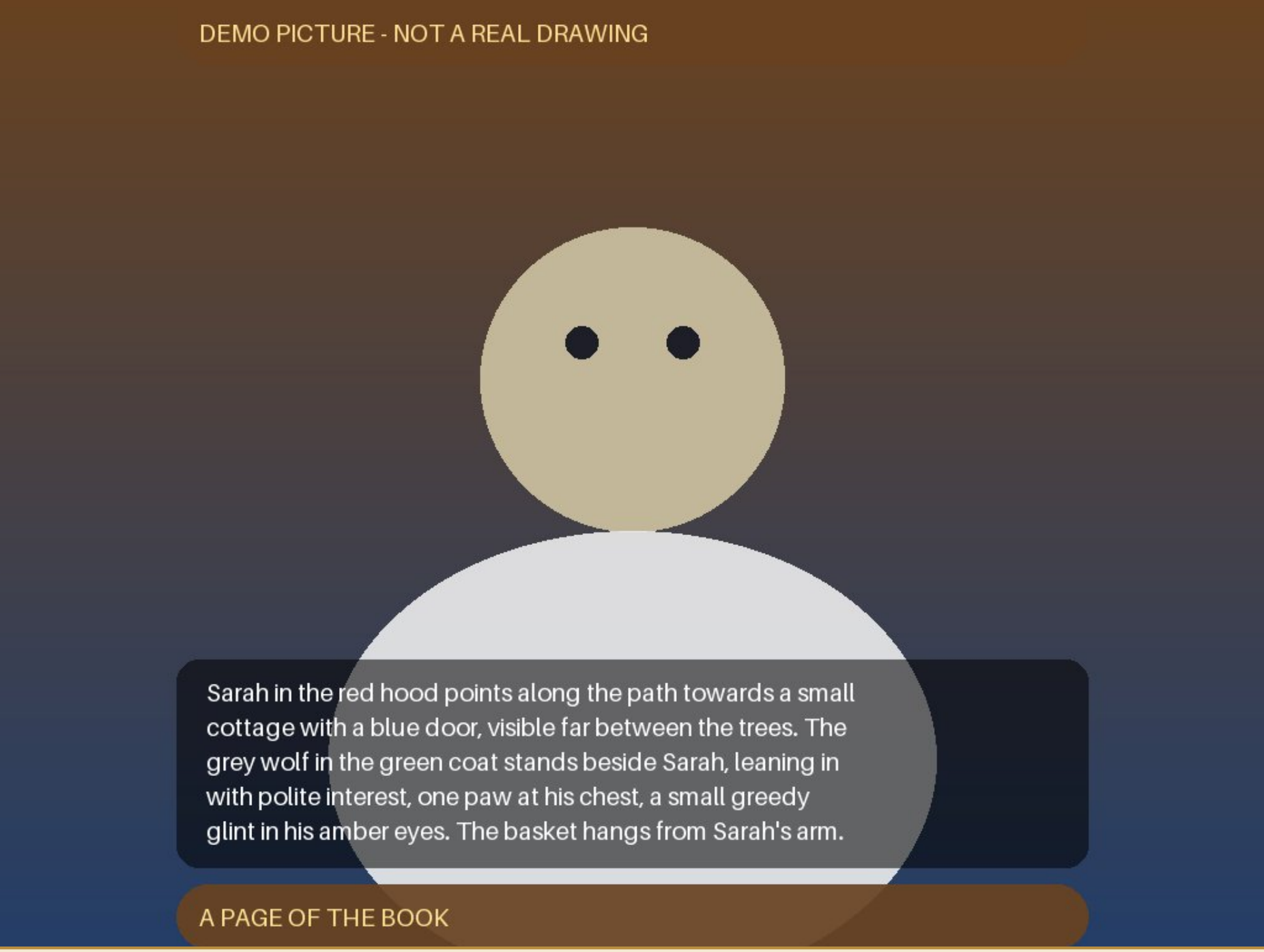
At the edge of the wood, the path was soft with old leaves. Birds sang in the tall trees, and the sun made small gold coins on the ground. Sarah held the basket with both hands and walked along the path, humming a little tune. Far away, Grandmother’s chimney smoke rose above the trees.

DEMO PICTURE - NOT A REAL DRAWING

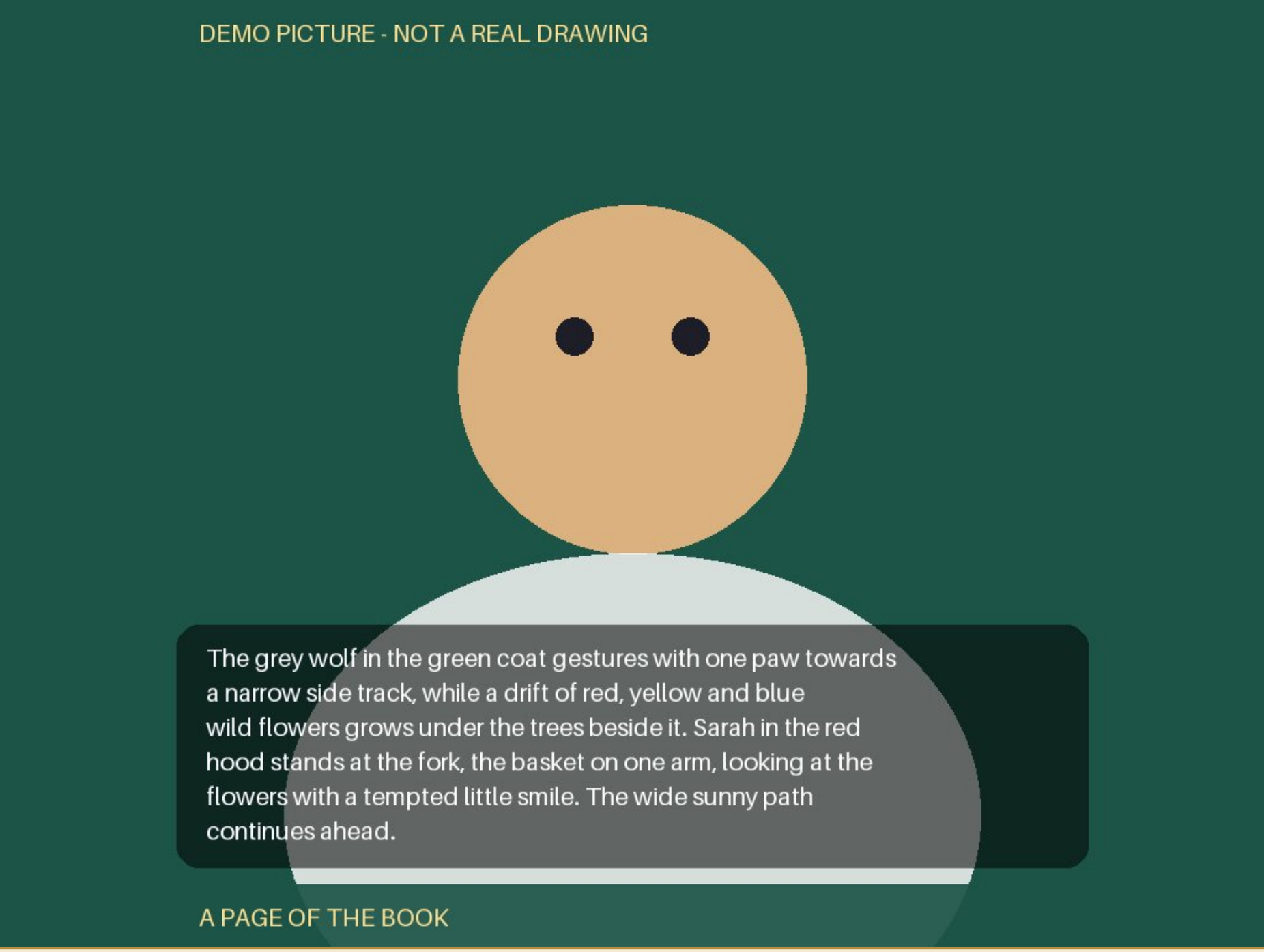


A PAGE OF THE BOOK

All at once a grey wolf stepped out from behind a tree. He was tall and thin, with a long brush tail and a smart green coat. ‘Good morning, little friend,’ he said, very politely. ‘What a pretty red hood. And where are you going so early?’ Sarah remembered her mother’s words, but the wolf smiled so kindly.



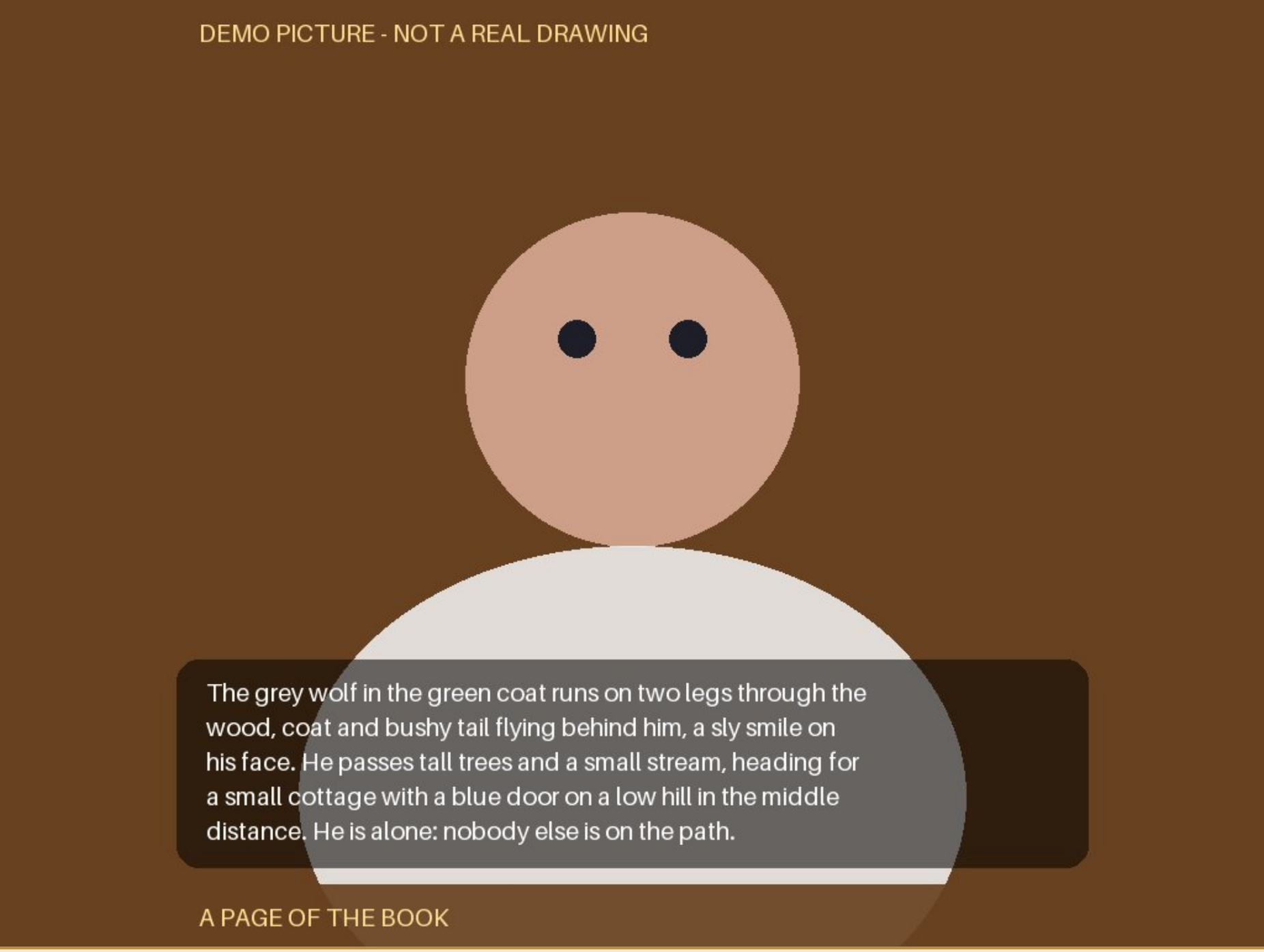
‘I am going to Grandmother’s house,’ said Sarah. ‘She is not well, and I am taking her bread and honey.’ The wolf nodded and licked his lips, but he kept his voice soft. ‘How kind you are,’ he said. ‘And does your grandmother live far away?’ Sarah pointed down the path, past the tall trees, to the little cottage with the blue door.



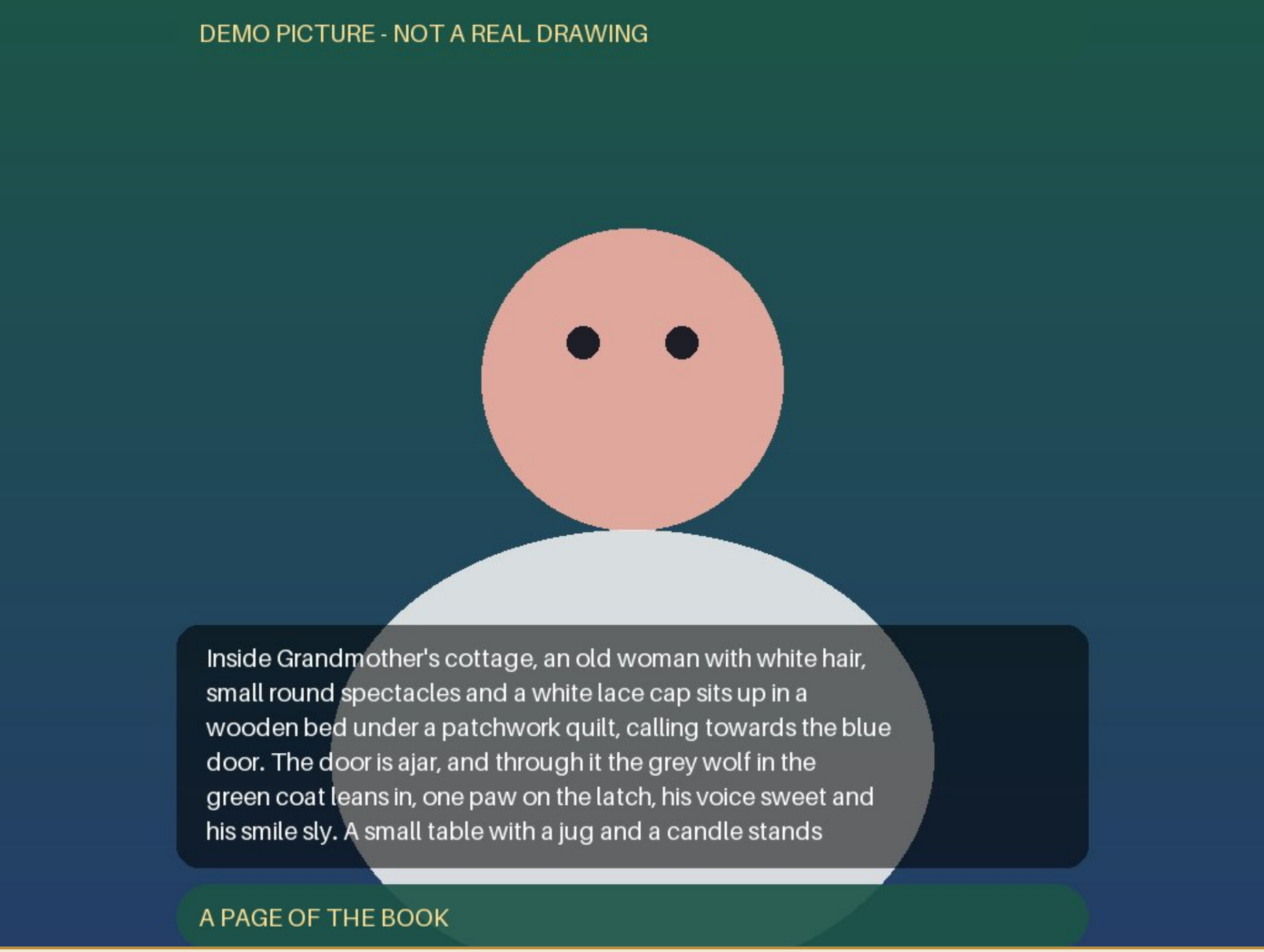
‘What a long way that is,’ said the wolf. ‘I know a short path through the wood. You could pick some flowers for her, too. Grandmothers love flowers.’ Sarah looked at the sunny path and then at the flowers growing under the trees. They were so pretty. ‘Perhaps just a few,’ she said, and stepped off the path.



Sarah picked one flower, then another, then a whole armful. The flowers were red and yellow and blue. She did not see the wolf slip away between the trees. She did not hear his soft feet on the leaves. She only hummed and picked, and the morning grew warmer and warmer.



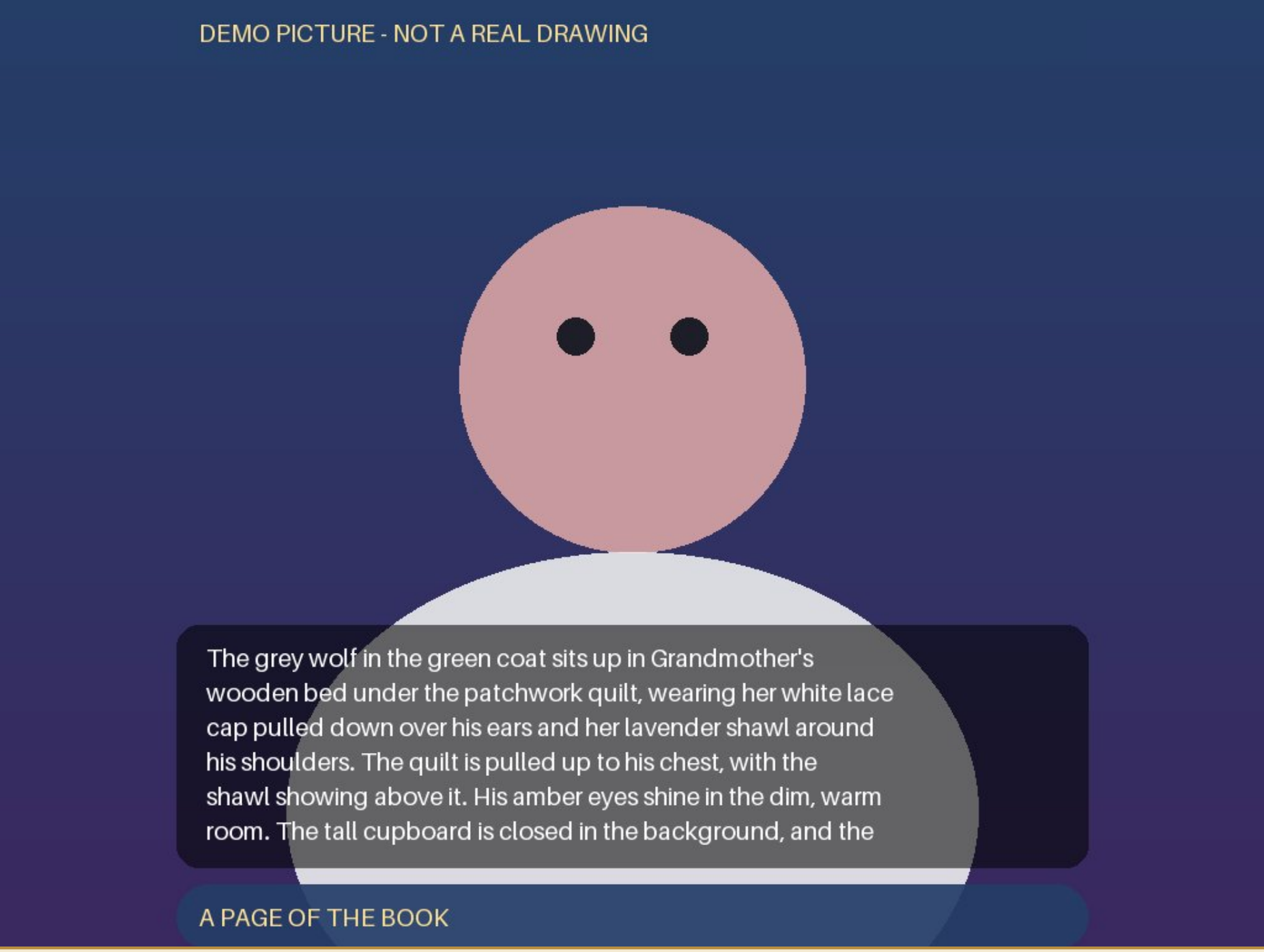
The wolf ran through the wood as fast as he could. He ran past the tall trees and over the stream and up the little hill. He reached Grandmother's cottage long before Sarah. He knocked on the blue door, once, twice, three times, and made his voice small and sweet.



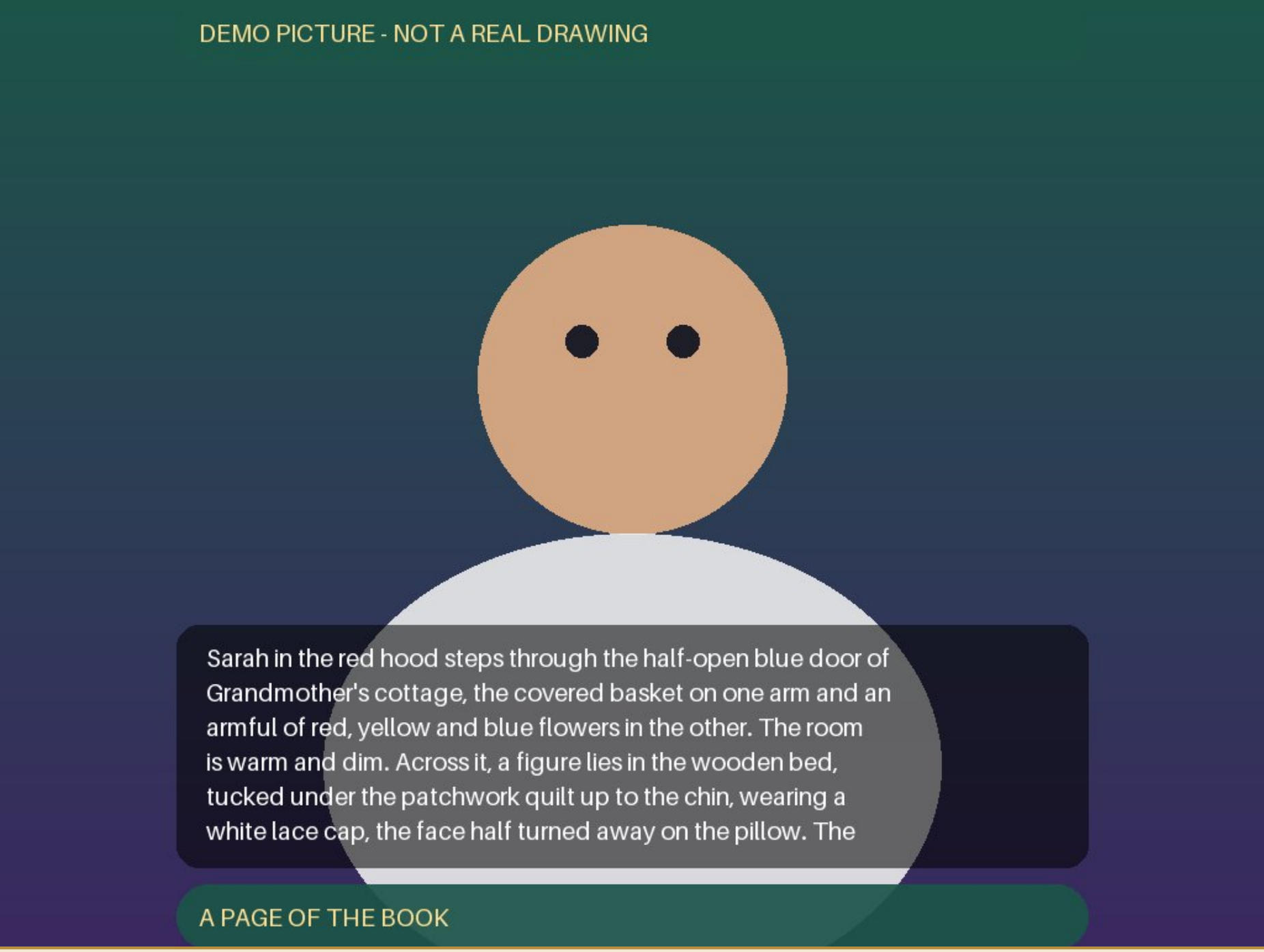
‘Who is there?’ called Grandmother from her bed. ‘It is me, your little Sarah,’ said the wolf, in a voice like a child’s. ‘I have brought you bread and honey.’ Grandmother was old and her ears were not sharp. ‘Lift the latch and come in, dear,’ she said. The wolf lifted the latch and went inside.



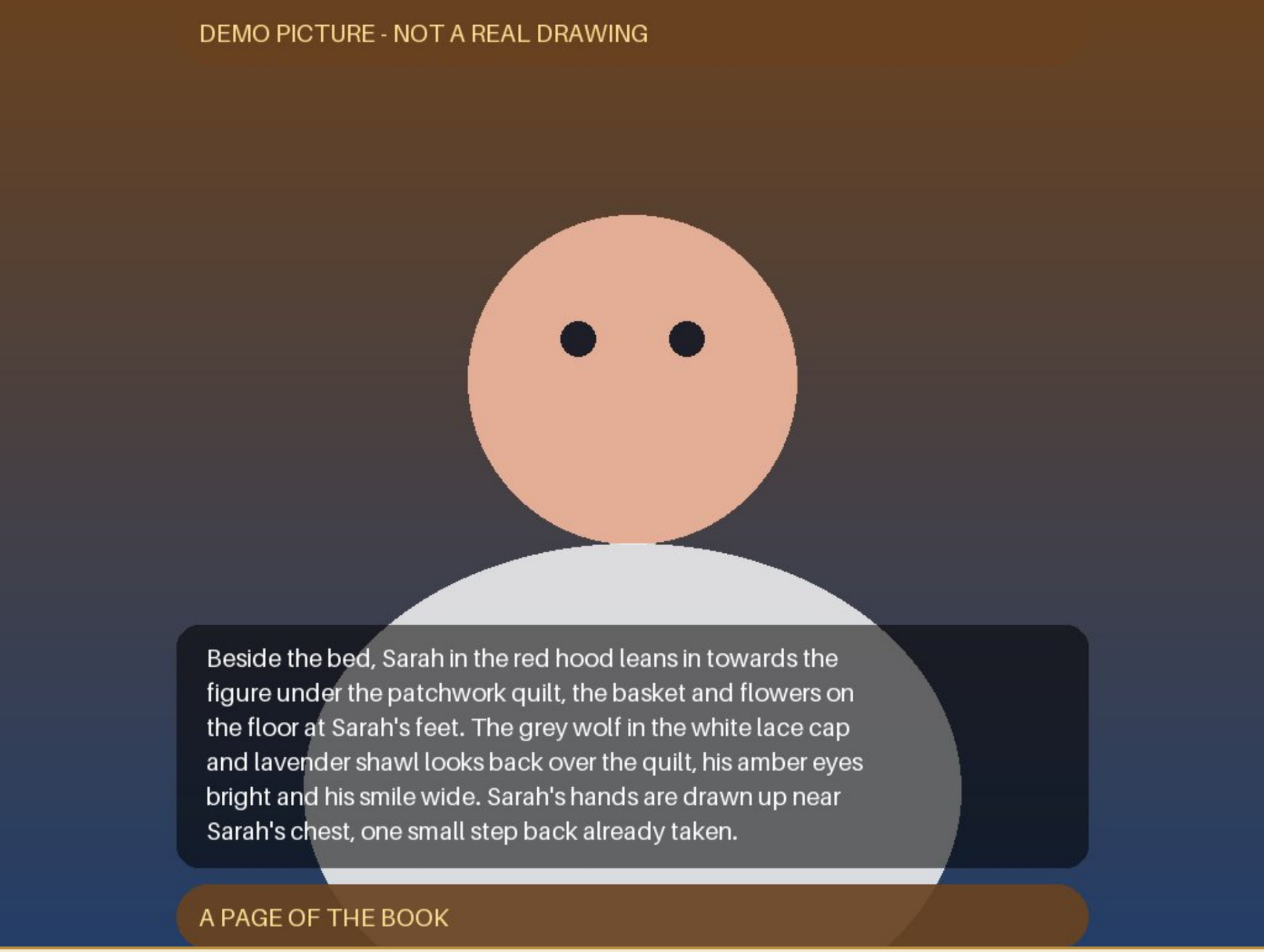
Grandmother sat up in bed and saw the wolf's grey face. She opened her mouth to call out, but the wolf raised one paw. 'Not a sound,' he said, 'and no one will be hurt.' He took her hand and helped her into the tall wooden cupboard, and shut the door. Then he put on her cap and her shawl and climbed into her bed.



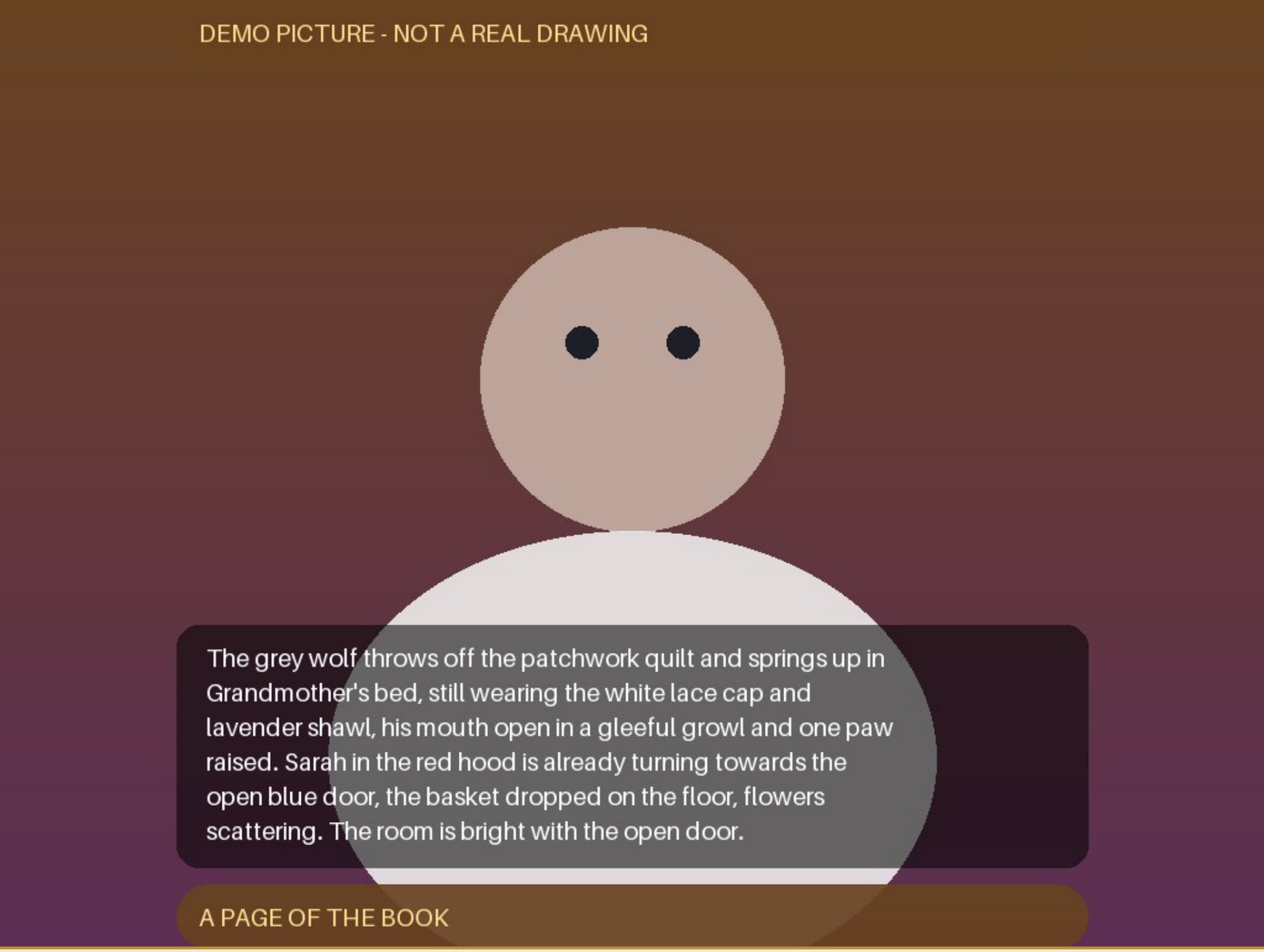
The wolf pulled the white cap down over his ears and wrapped the shawl around his shoulders. He got into her bed and pulled up the blanket. In the warm, dark room, with the curtains half closed, he looked almost like Grandmother. He waited, and his bright eyes shone in the dim light.



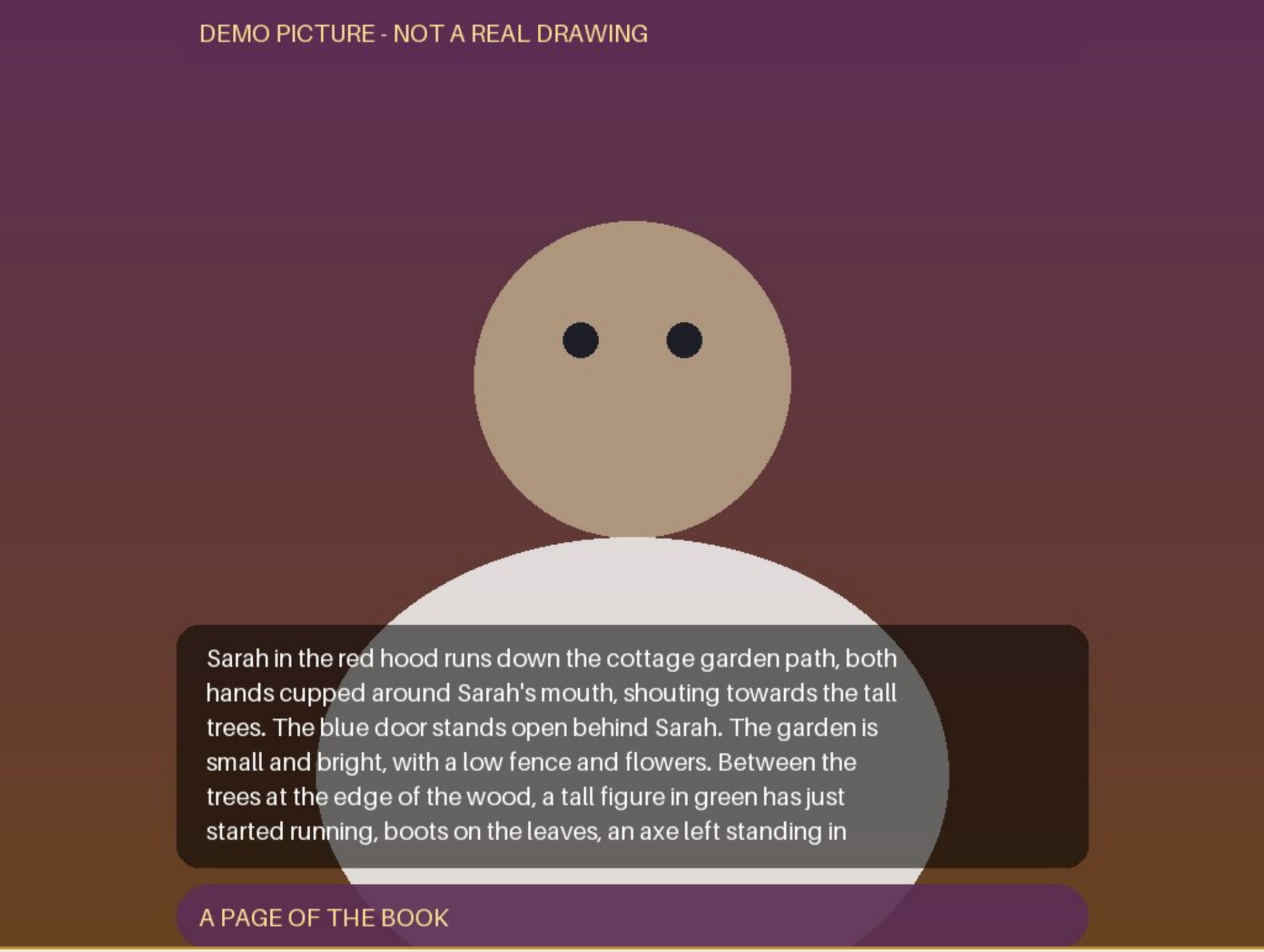
Sarah came up the garden path with the basket and the flowers. The blue door stood open, just a little. ‘Grandmother?’ she called. There was no answer. She went inside. The room was warm and quiet, and someone was lying in the bed with a white cap on.



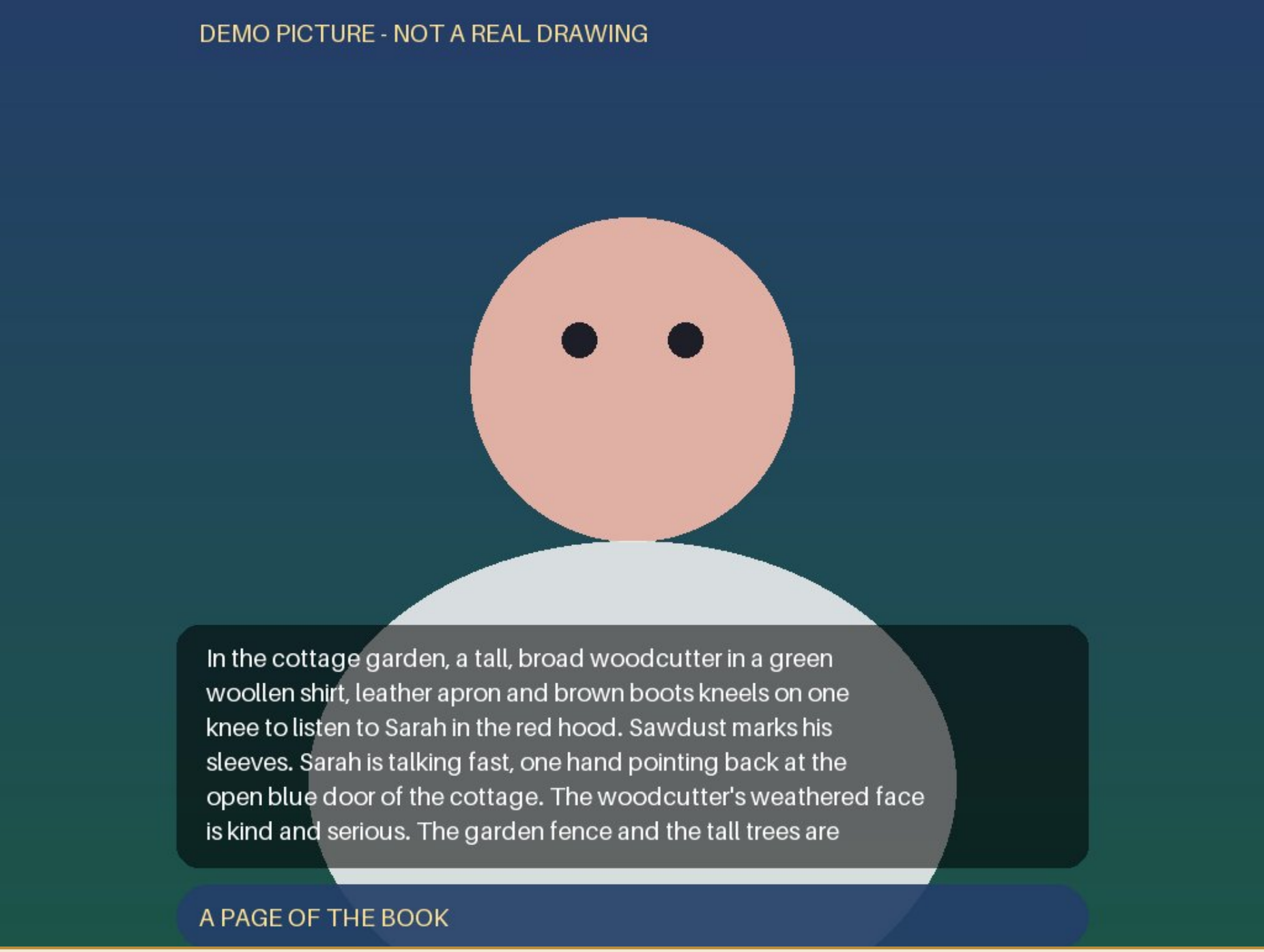
‘Grandmother, what big ears you have,’ said Sarah. ‘All the better to hear you with, my dear,’ said the wolf. ‘And Grandmother, what big eyes you have.’ ‘All the better to see you with,’ said the wolf. His voice was not quite like Grandmother’s voice. It was deeper, and it made Sarah take one small step back.



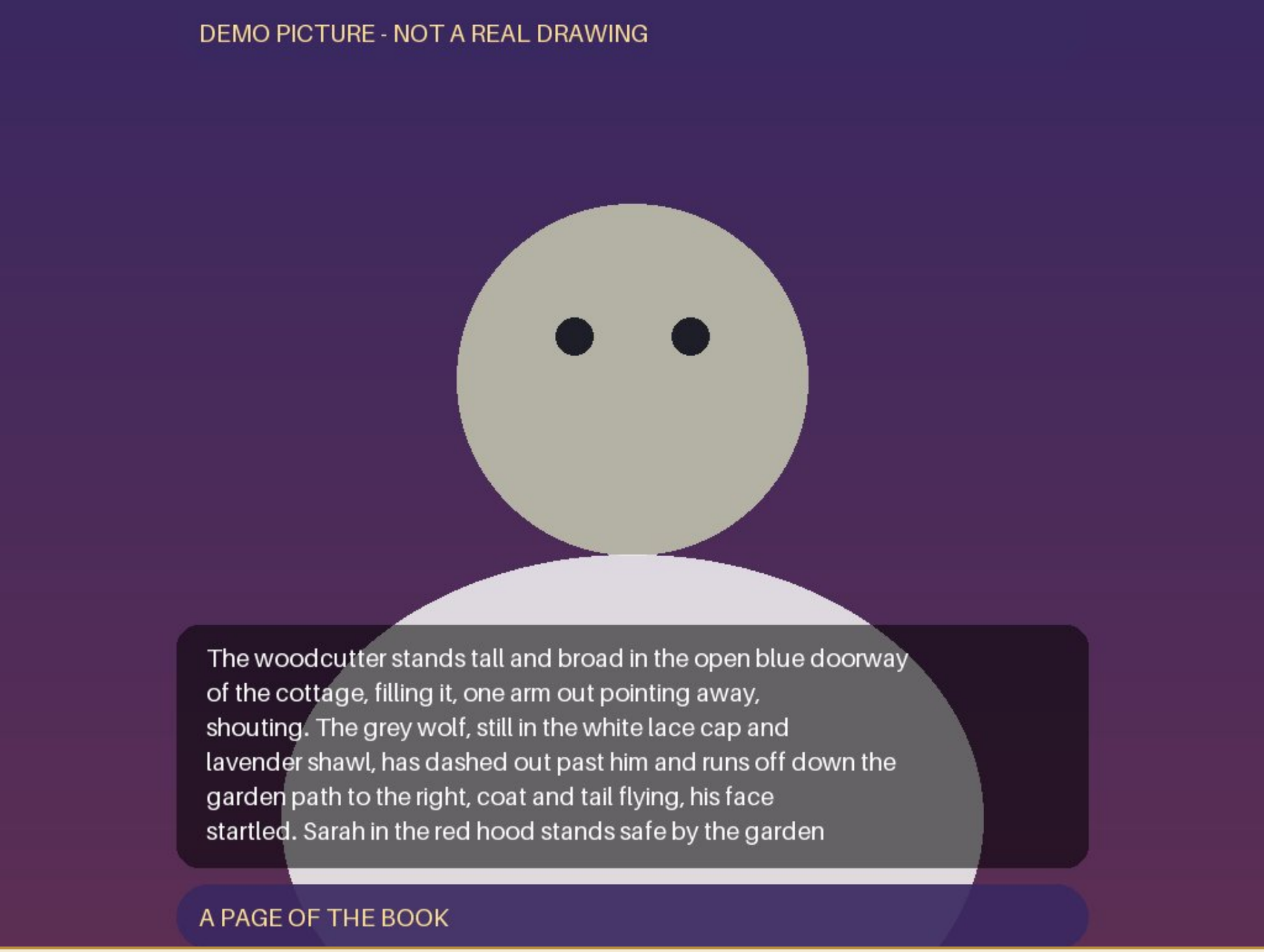
‘And Grandmother, what big teeth you have!’ said Sarah. The wolf threw off the blanket and sat up tall in the bed. ‘All the better to gobble you up!’ he growled. Sarah cried out and ran for the door, but the wolf was already out of the bed and coming after her.



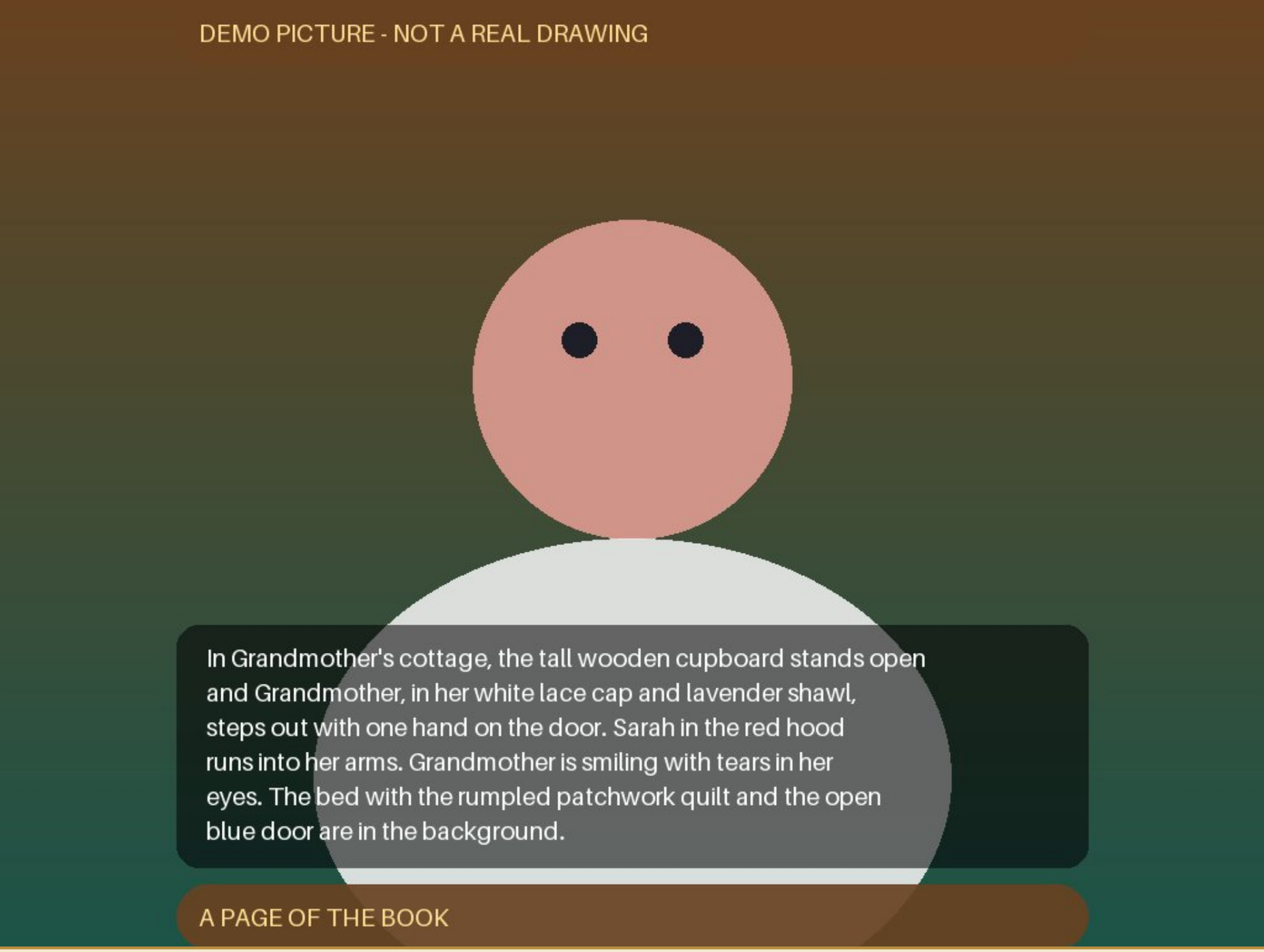
Sarah ran out of the cottage and along the garden path. ‘Help!’ she shouted as loud as she could. ‘Help! The wolf is in Grandmother’s house!’ The wood was quiet for one moment. Then, from the trees, came the sound of an axe set down and quick boots on the leaves.



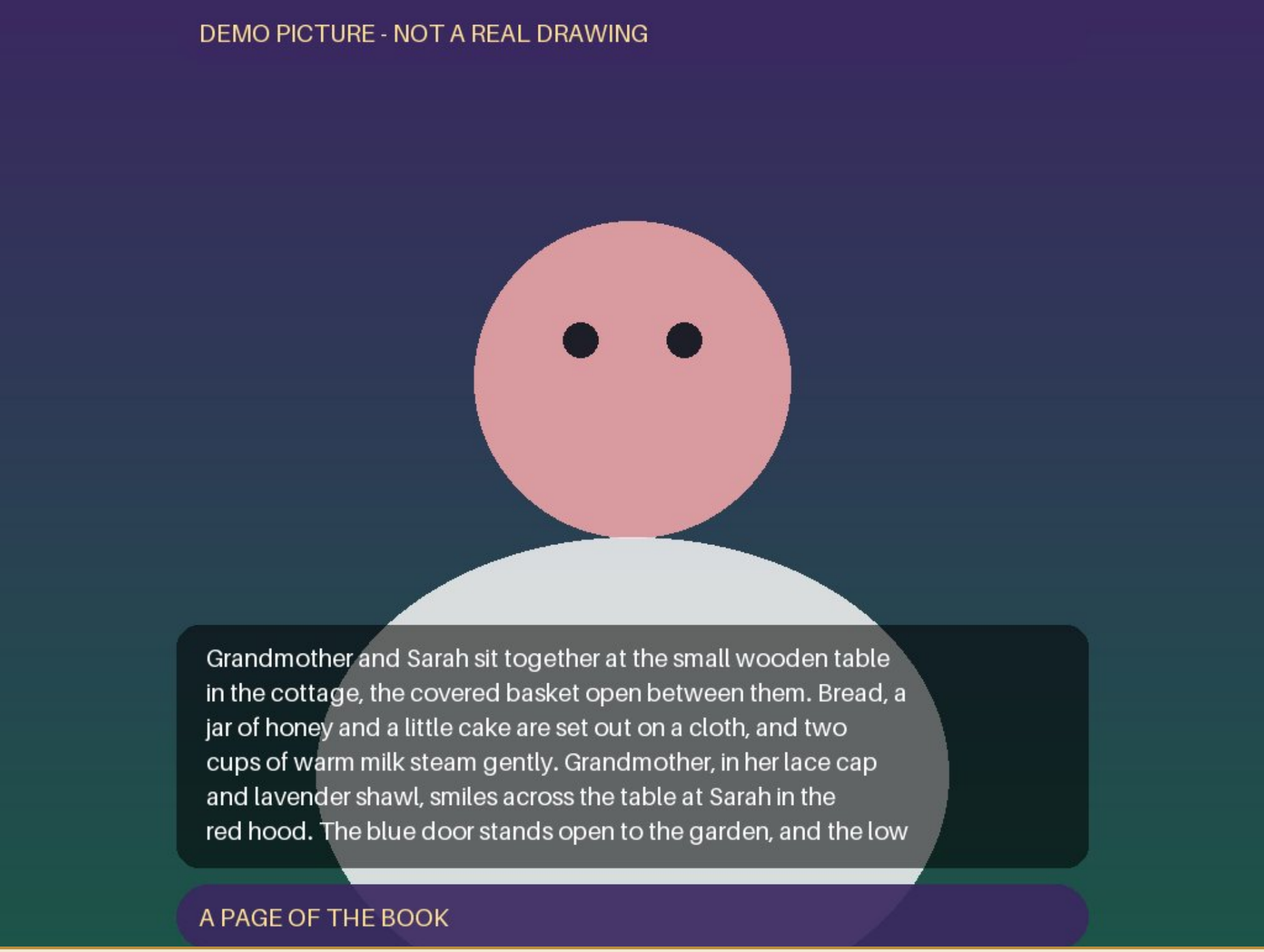
The woodcutter came running. He was tall and strong, with a kind, weathered face and sawdust on his sleeves. ‘What is wrong, little one?’ he asked. Sarah pointed at the cottage and told him everything, all in a rush. The woodcutter listened, and his face grew serious.



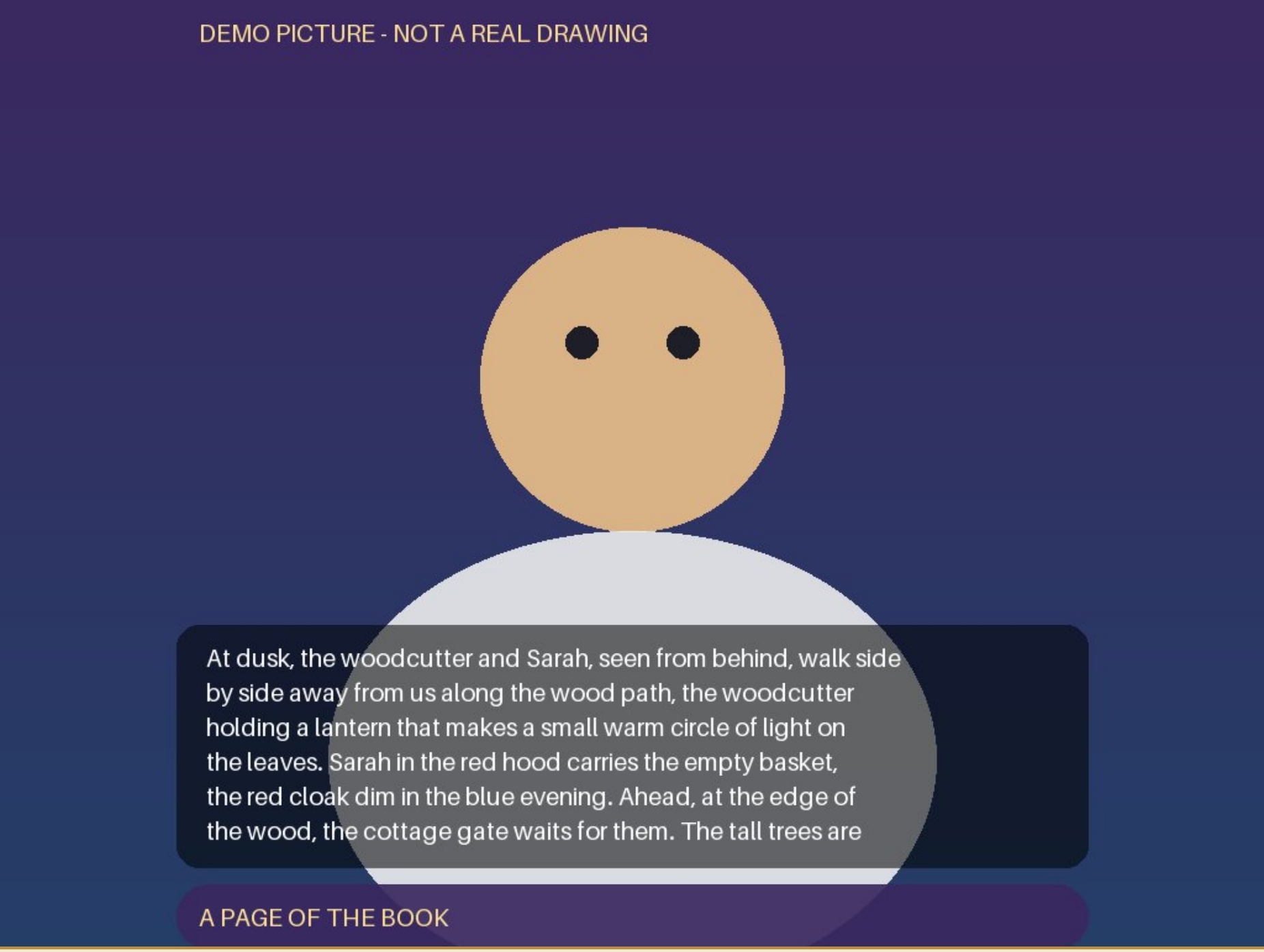
The woodcutter strode to the cottage door and threw it open. ‘Out with you, wolf!’ he shouted. ‘Go back to the wood and do not come back!’ The wolf took one look at him, jumped off the bed, and ran out through the door. He ran past the garden and over the hill, and nobody in the village saw him again.



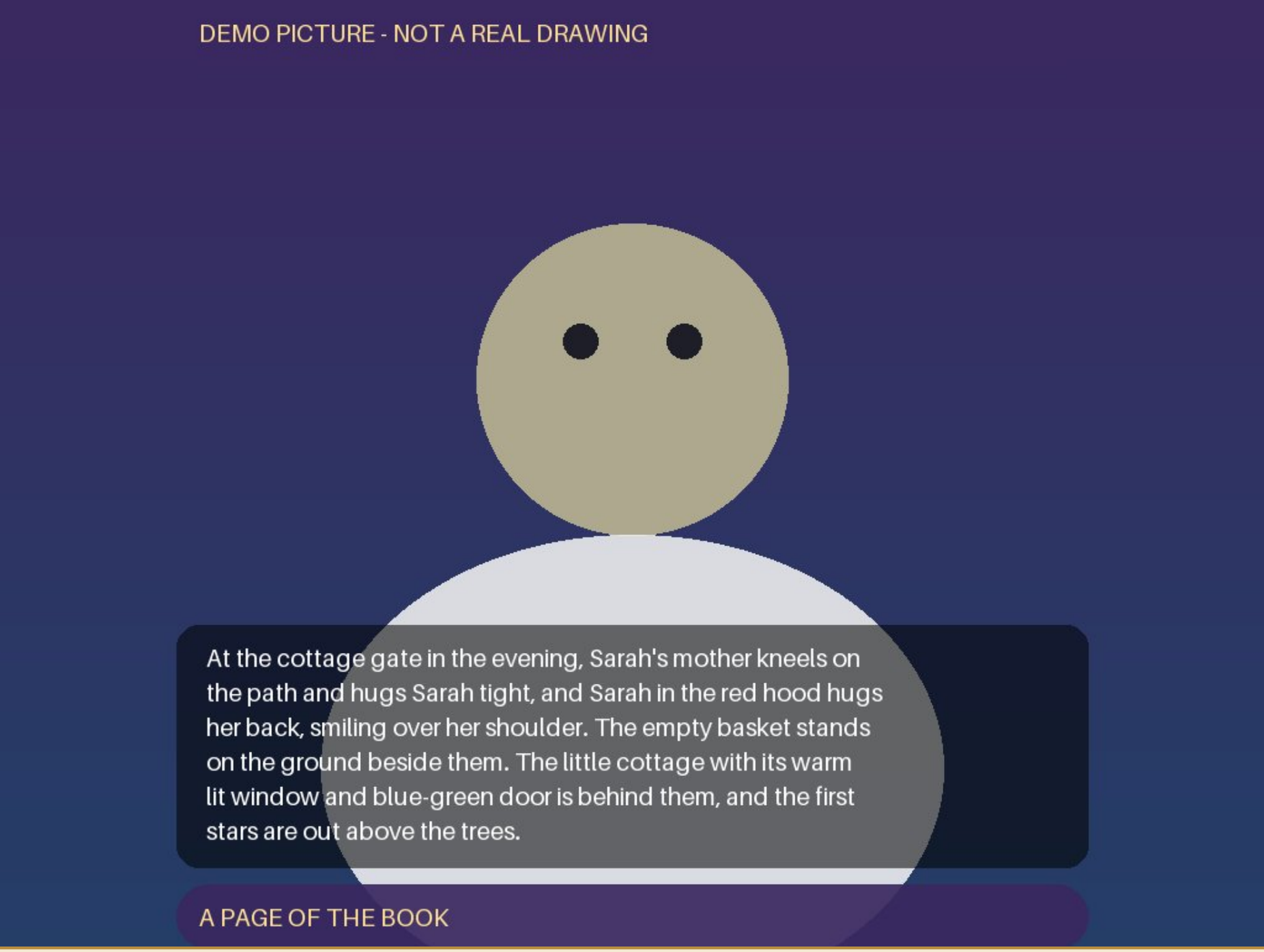
The woodcutter opened the tall cupboard, and Grandmother stepped out, safe and sound. She was a little shaky, but she was smiling. Sarah ran to her and hugged her tight. ‘You are safe,’ said Grandmother. ‘And so are you,’ said Sarah. The little cottage felt warm and bright again.



They sat down together at the little table. Sarah opened the basket and set out the bread, the honey and the cake. Grandmother poured warm milk into two cups. They talked quietly while they ate, and the little cottage filled with the smell of bread. Outside, the sun moved slowly over the trees, and the blue door stayed open to the warm air.



When the sky turned pink and grey, the woodcutter walked Sarah home through the wood. He carried a lantern, and its light made a small warm circle on the path. ‘Stay on the path,’ he said, ‘and do not talk to strange wolves.’ Sarah promised. At the edge of the wood, her mother was waiting.



Sarah ran into her mother’s arms and told her the whole tale. The basket was empty, the flowers were wilted, and the red hood was a little dirty. But Sarah was home. Mother hugged her close and did not scold. And from that day on, Sarah always stayed on the path, and always knocked before going in.

The End

About Sarah



For Sarah, who is not afraid of the dark.
This book stars Sarah.
Sarah is 6 years old.
In real life, Sarah is a forest ranger.
Loves wolves, red boots and pancakes.